# First Aid: Primary Survey Basics

*Study notes — Provision of First Aid Services unit. The standard primary survey framework used in emergency first response.*

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## DRSABCD framework

- Danger — check the scene is safe for you, bystanders, and the casualty
- Response — check for a response (talk, touch, squeeze shoulders)
- Send for help — call emergency services or direct someone to
- Airway — open and check the airway is clear
- Breathing — look, listen, and feel for normal breathing
- CPR — start chest compressions if not breathing normally
- Defibrillation — attach an AED as soon as one is available

## Recovery position

- Used for an unresponsive casualty who is breathing normally
- Keeps the airway open and allows fluid to drain from the mouth

## Common first aid priorities

- Severe bleeding — direct pressure, elevate if possible, do not remove embedded objects
- Burns — cool with running water, cover with non-stick dressing, do not use ice
- Suspected fracture — immobilise, avoid moving the casualty unnecessarily

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